

Learning & Development and Tuition Assistance Policy

Version 2026.1 | Learning Budgets, Mandatory Compliance Training, and Career Growth Pathways

Section 1: Learning & Development Philosophy

The company invests in continuous employee growth through a blended model of formal training, on-the-job stretch assignments, mentorship, and external certification support. The People Development team publishes a refreshed catalog of internal courses each quarter, mapped to the competency framework used in the annual performance appraisal.

Section 2: Individual Learning Budget & Reimbursement

Grade Band	Annual Learning Budget	Conference / Certification Cap	Approval Required
L1 - L2	\$1,000 USD	\$500 USD per item	Manager
L3 - L4	\$2,000 USD	\$1,200 USD per item	Manager
L5 - L6	\$3,500 USD	\$2,500 USD per item	Department VP
L7	\$5,000 USD	No per-item cap	CEO office

Unused learning budget does not carry over to the following calendar year. Reimbursement claims must be filed under expense code EXP-LND-330 within 30 days of course or exam completion, accompanied by a certificate or attendance confirmation.

Section 3: Mandatory Compliance Training

All employees must complete the following training within 30 days of hire and annually thereafter: Code of Conduct & Ethics, Anti-Harassment & Anti-Discrimination, Information Security Awareness, and Data Privacy Fundamentals.

People-managers additionally complete Manager Essentials training within their first 90 days of assuming direct reports.

Completion rates are reported to the Executive People Committee quarterly, and overdue training is escalated to the employee's manager after a 15-day grace period.

Section 4: Tuition Assistance for Degree & Certification Programs

Employees with at least 1 year of continuous service may apply for tuition assistance toward a job-relevant degree or professional certification, reimbursed up to \$5,250 USD per calendar year upon successful completion (grade C or above, or pass/fail equivalent). Employees who resign within 12 months of receiving tuition assistance repay a prorated portion under the standard training-bond schedule.

Section 5: Internal Mobility, Mentorship & Leadership Development

- **Internal Mobility:** Employees in their current role for 12+ months may apply to internal postings without requiring current-manager pre-approval to apply, though a transition conversation is expected before offer.
- **Mentorship Program:** Voluntary pairing of employees with senior mentors outside their reporting line, running in structured 6-month cohorts twice a year.
- **Leadership Development Track:** Grade L4+ employees identified in succession planning attend a structured 9-month leadership program combining coaching, 360-degree feedback, and a capstone business project reviewed by the executive team.

Section 6: Skills Framework & Learning Paths by Function

Function	Core Competencies Assessed	Recommended Learning Path
Engineering	System design, code quality, incident response	Technical Ladder Track (self-paced + quarterly workshop)
Sales & Customer Success	Consultative selling, negotiation, account planning	Sales Excellence Certification (external, company-funded)
People Management	Coaching, delegation, difficult conversations	Manager Essentials + ongoing Manager Forum
Finance & Operations	Financial modeling, process excellence, risk controls	FP&A; Bootcamp + Lean Six Sigma Green Belt

Section 7: Manager Responsibilities in Employee Development

Every manager is expected to hold at least one dedicated career-development conversation with each direct report per quarter, separate from routine work status check-ins, and to document agreed development actions in the performance system. Managers approving learning-budget spend are responsible for confirming the activity is role-relevant; approvals for clearly non-role-relevant spend may be reversed by Finance during quarterly expense audits.

Section 8: Measuring Learning & Development Effectiveness

The People Development team tracks four core metrics each quarter: learning-budget utilization rate by function, completion rate for mandatory compliance training, internal-mobility fill rate (percentage of open roles filled by internal candidates), and post-training satisfaction scores collected via a standardized survey within 2 weeks of course completion. Results are reviewed with the Executive People Committee each quarter and inform the following year's catalog and budget planning.

Section 9: External Conference & Speaking Engagement Policy

Employees invited to speak at an external industry conference on company-related work may request sponsorship of travel and registration costs in addition to their standard learning budget, subject to Corporate Communications review of any public-facing materials at least 10 business days before the event. Attendance as a non-speaking delegate draws from the employee's standard annual learning budget described in Section 2.

Section 10: Succession Planning & High-Potential Identification

Each function conducts an annual talent review identifying high-potential employees and at least one identified successor for every Grade L5+ role. High-potential designation is communicated to the employee along with a tailored development plan, and is reassessed annually rather than treated as a permanent label; the designation itself carries no automatic compensation change but is a key input into promotion and stretch-assignment decisions.

Section 11: Learning Technology Platform & Access

All employees have unlimited access to the enterprise learning platform, which hosts self-paced technical courses, leadership content, and compliance modules from a mix of internal subject-matter experts and licensed third-party providers. Course completions sync automatically to the employee's learning record and are visible to the employee's manager to support development-conversation planning; they are not visible to other employees or used in performance calibration beyond the mandatory compliance completion metric described in Section 3.

Section 12: Cross-Functional Rotation & Stretch Assignments

Employees with 18+ months of tenure in their current function may apply for a structured 3-to-6-month cross-functional rotation, subject to both the sending and receiving manager's agreement and business continuity coverage for the sending team. Rotations are documented with clear success criteria agreed upfront, and the employee's grade and base compensation are unaffected during the rotation regardless of the receiving team's typical band for that type of work.

Stretch assignments — temporary expanded scope without a formal rotation or role change — are the most commonly used development lever and are logged in the performance system so they are visible during promotion and calibration discussions, ensuring employees receive credit for expanded contribution even before a formal title change.